

How much leaf is left?

A loop goes somewhere. · Curiosity day

Name _____

Date _____



PRETEND JOURNEY DISTANCES · MILLIMETERS

Part	Whole route	First stretch	Next stretch
Length (mm)	32	12	9

A drawing model for a journey. Use the invented table distances, not the picture's size or dot spacing.

Use the table numbers. The picture is not a ruler.

1. Walk 12 mm, then 9 mm. How far in all?

12 + 9 = _____

Show your thinking.

2. Route is 32 mm. After 12 mm and 9 mm, how much is left? Show both steps.

32 - (12 + 9) = _____

Show your thinking.

3. Add 8 mm to the 32 mm route. After a 21 mm walk, how much is left?

(32 + 8) - 21 = _____

Show your thinking.

4. A trip goes 7 mm, then 6 mm, then 5 mm. How far in all?

7 + 6 + 5 = _____

Show your thinking.

5. Trip A: 12+9 mm. Trip B: 7+6+5 mm. Which is longer, and by how much?

(12 + 9) - (7 + 6 + 5) = _____

Show your thinking.

6. 11 mm left. Two friends share it as evenly as they can. How much each, and how much left over?

11 ÷ 2 = _____

Show your thinking.

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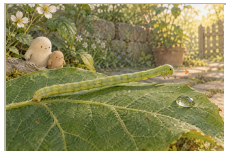
Date _____



Little spots a green arch on the leaf. "A tiny bridge!" The arch flattens, and a small head reaches past a vein. Big watches from the path. Bending is how this caterpillar starts a trip across the same leaf vein.



Front grips hold the leaf. The rear slides closer and the long middle lifts into a tall loop. Soft grips near the rear are prolegs — fleshy holders, not jointed walking legs. "No walking legs under that middle," Little says.



The prolegs anchor the rear: they hold it in place. The front stretches ahead as the body straightens. When the front grips again, the rear can follow. One end holds; the other moves. Loop by loop, the leaf gets shorter.



Little draws the head before a vein fork, then after it on the same leaf vein. The two marks are evidence — clues that can support an idea. "It passed the fork!" That idea is an inference: an idea drawn from evidence.



"Does every loop go one inch?" Little asks. The name sounds like a ruler, but real steps vary. So Little invents a pretend route with made-up distances. A model can answer a math question without turning the picture into a measuring stick.



Little imagines later chapters. The caterpillar becomes a pupa, then a moth. That change of body form is metamorphosis, and it takes time. "A new shape after all those loops," Little grins.

Think about it: What evidence shows the head traveled rather than only bending in place? Why compare it with the same vein fork? During the reach, what anchors the rear? Predict what could happen if that grip slipped, and explain why.

Explain a tiny grip.

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Choose a scene. Write two linked sentences: one observation, then an explanation using because. Draw a detail that supports your idea.



The rear catches up



A grip, then a reach



The leaf keeps a clue

Draw the detail you noticed. Add an arrow to show movement or a dot to show position.

prolegs · anchor · loop · reach · evidence · inference · because

The middle rises because ... What happens when the rear gets closer to the gripping front?

The rear grip matters because ... What keeps the body in place while the front reaches?

I infer that it moved because ... Compare the head with the same vein fork in both sketches.

Reread your words. Does the detail support your explanation? Check the first capital and each ending mark.